STATE SCAN

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UP: YOGI'S SAFFRON TOUR *PG 18*

ARUN KUMAR



POLICY RESET
Uttarakhand CM Pushkar Dhami; right, students at a madrasa



DEEPAK CHHABRA

UTTARAKHAND

REFORMING MINORITY EDUCATION

Uttarakhand abolishes its madrasa board—all minority-run education institutions will now be mainstreamed under a new state authority

By **Avaneesh Mishra**

IS IT A PIECE OF ESSENTIAL REFORM? OR A PROFOUNDLY political move, incongruent with constitutional guarantees? Both sides are being argued passionately as Uttarakhand becomes the first Indian state to abolish its statutory madrasa board. A new authority will govern education institutions run by all six notified minority communities. As the Pushkar Singh Dhami government puts it, this is mainstreaming—aligning not only with the ideology of the ruling Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP), but also the imperative of uniform pedagogy. The minority institutions, overnight bereft of the legal ground under their feet, say those standards could just as well have been ensured without such sweeping cooption.

After its Uniform Civil Code (UCC), a series of moves like place renamings and progressively more stringent anti-conversion laws had paved Uttarakhand's passage to being a frontline